

Employee Attrition: What the Data Tells Us

Prepared for: HR Leadership | Based on 1,470 employee records

16.1% of employees left the company	29.8% of leavers exit within their first 2 years	3x higher exit rate when working overtime
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What's Driving People to Leave

Three factors stand out consistently in the data as the strongest warning signs that an employee is at risk of leaving:

- Working overtime regularly - employees who work overtime leave at 30.5%, compared to just 10.4% for those who don't.
- Lower pay relative to peers - employees who left earned a median of ₹3,202/month, versus ₹5,204/month for those who stayed (about 38% less).
- Being new to the company - almost 3 in 10 employees who leave do so within their first two years on the job; after that, the risk drops sharply.

Sales Representatives are the highest-risk role by far, with close to 40% leaving - roughly double the next closest role. Sales as a department, and Human Resources, also run well above the company-wide average.

Is It Just About Salary?

Not entirely. Pay is clearly connected to attrition, but it isn't acting alone - overtime nearly triples the leaving rate by itself, and early tenure more than doubles it, regardless of salary. A pay increase on its own is unlikely to fully solve the problem if workload and on boarding are not also addressed.

Recommended Actions

- Prioritize retention conversations with Sales Representatives and anyone on sustained overtime - a manager check-in within 90 days of extended overtime, before resignation intent sets in.
- Strengthen the first-two-year experience - structured mentorship and career-growth check-ins at 6 and 18 months, since this is the single highest-risk window for losing people.

About the Prediction Model & Its Limits

I built a model that estimates each employee's risk of leaving using their job, pay, tenure, and satisfaction data. It correctly flags about 6 out of 10 employees who go on to leave - useful, but not perfect. When it does flag someone as "at risk," that flag is right about 1 in 3 times. The model should be treated as a prioritization tool to guide where to focus retention conversations first - not as a final decision-maker about any individual employee.